

Château Pichon Longueville – Comtesse de Lalande 2010

CSPC# 765466

750mlx12

13.0% alc./vol.

CSPC# 869816

750mlx12

13.0% alc./vol.

Grape Variety
Appellation

66% Cabernet Sauvignon, 24% Merlot, 7% Cabernet Franc, 3% Petit Verdot.

Pauillac
2nd Growth

Website
General Info

<http://www.pichon-comtesse.com/>

"A First Class Second Cru" was how the Wine Spectator magazine very aptly described Château Pichon Lalande! The latter was created as a result of the splitting of the original Château Pichon Longueville in 1850 when the owner established his children's inheritance: his son took charge of the current Pichon Longueville Baron, while his daughter, Virginie, who was married to the Comte de Lalande, received the other part of the property, hence the addition of "Comtesse de Lalande". A determined figure with a passion for wine, Virginie oversaw the property's rise and its establishment in its own right. It remained within her family until 1925, when it was purchased by Edouard and Louis Mialhe. From 1978 to 2007 the domaine was managed by another grande dame: Edouard Mialhe's daughter, May-Eliane de Lencquesaing. Grand Chancellor of Bordeaux's Wine Academy, she was known as La Générale, thanks to her husband's military career. The feminine influence of the Comtesse a century earlier could not have found a finer echo, and Pichon Lalande's impassioned history is reflected in the special affection that connoisseurs have always had for the château's wines. The property was purchased by the Rouzaud family in 2007, the owners, among other interests, of Roederer champagne.

Winemaker
Vintage

Philippe Moreau

The vineyard cycle began with a cold, relatively wet winter, resulting in a slightly later bud-break than in 2009, in mid-April. Growth was then boosted by dry, sunny weather in April. May and June were characterized by alternating periods of rain and sunshine. June began with a cold spell that complicated the flowering of the Merlot, resulting in flower abortion and uneven grape size. Fortunately, July was very dry (less than 20 mm of rain) with relatively high temperatures, which helped the vines to catch up from the delays caused during flowering. August and September were very dry, with beautiful daytime temperatures and cool nights creating ideal conditions for the grapes to slowly reach optimum ripeness.

Vineyards

Of the property's 75 hectares, 11 are in the commune of Saint Julien, giving the wines a certain elegance, uncommon for Pauillac. In addition to the predominant Cabernet Sauvignon, which gives the wines a great capacity to age, there is also a high proportion of Merlot, giving them a remarkable suppleness especially when young. The grand vin of Pichon Comtesse thus exquisitely marries the concentration of a Pauillac with very distinct tannins. Its exceptional terroir overlooking the Gironde means it can effectively resist harsh winters and overly warm summers. In the closed circle of the finest Bordeaux. To be sampled after 10 to 30 years

Harvest
Maturation
Tasting Notes

The harvest took place from September 22, to October 13

The wine is fermented in stainless steel cuvées and then matured in oak barriques (50% new) for 18 months.

It is great to see Pichon-Lalande back on superb form in 2006 with a wine whose purity and linear cassis fruit is reminiscent of their cracking 1996. General Manager Gildas d'Ollone and his team have produced a cerebral yet beguiling Pichon-Lalande full of sensual, exotic aromatics and pure supple flavours. This is a massive Pichon softened by a silky texture and velvety finish. New owners Louis Roederer must be delighted with their first vintage here, and rightly so. Drink: 2015-2030.

Serve with
Production
Cellaring

Light Poultry and Meat

13,333 cases made.

Drink from 2022-2048



Scores/Awards **95+ points** - Robert Parker, Wine Advocate #205 - February 2013
95 points - Neal Martin, Wine Journal - March 2014
95 points - Neal Martin, Wine Journal - March 2013
94 points - James Suckling, JamesSuckling.com - February 2013
96 points / Cellar Selection - Roger Voss, Wine Enthusiast - February 2013
18.5 points - Jancis Robinson, JancisRobinson.com - July 2015
17 points - Richard Hemming, JancisRobinson.com - November 2014
17.5 points - Richard Hemming, JancisRobinson.com - October 2014
16.5 points - Jancis Robinson, JancisRobinson.com - January 2014
17 points - Julia Harding, JancisRobinson.com - November 2012
17.5 points - Julia Harding, JancisRobinson.com - March 2012
17 points - Jancis Robinson, JancisRobinson.com - April 2011
18.5 points - Stephen Spurrier, Decanter.com - April 2011
96 points - Jeff Leve, thewinecellarinsider.com - November 12, 2018
95 points - Jeff Leve, thewinecellarinsider.com - July 12, 2017
95+ points - Jeremy Williams, winewordsandvideotape.com - November 2014
95 points - Jeremy Williams, winewordsandvideotape.com - November 2012
97 points - Tim Atkin, MW - timatkin.com - April 2011
17 points - Farr Vintner - April 2011
94 points - Jeannie Cho Lee MW, asianpalate.com - April 2011
98+ points - Antonio Galloni, Vinous - October 2017
91 points - Antonio Galloni, Vinous - July 2013
95 points - Falstaff Magazine
18.5 points - Gault & Millau
17.5 points - Vinum Wine Magazine
18.5 points - La Revue du Vin France
17 points - Bettane & Desseauve
